

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.02

UTIL0.09

HEALT0.12

COMM.0.33

INDUS0.55

ENERG0.58

FINAN0.98

TECHN1.31

CONS.1.43

CONS.2.39

MATER9.90

1

AMZN

BUY

\$265.84

+2.46%

8/10

Retail juggernaut with a hidden AI/cloud engine (AWS) benefiting from

2

HOOD

BUY

\$95.77

+4.63%

8/10

Retail brokerage turning into a crypto+equities super-app, riding a fr

3

NVDA

BUY

\$217.56

-0.99%

8/10

The AI infrastructure buildout is still the biggest capital cycle in a

Big options bets on MRK (Other) — 16.2x normal volume, P/C 0.13, largest: CALL \$155 (3.4x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No major earnings this week

Consumer Confidence

Date: 2026-08-24

MEDIUM

VIX at 15.8 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

Consumer Confidence [MEDIUM]

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what's interesting: the biggest money is piling into the most defensive, rate-sensitive corners of the market — Real Estate, Utilities, and Healthcare are seeing wildly bullish call buying, which usually means institutions are betting the Fed cuts rates sooner than expected and are also positioning for a slower economy where you want boring, dividend-paying stuff.

The Real Estate flow is especially loud and probably tied to expectations that housing legislation, refinancing waves, or a dovish Fed pivot are coming, while Healthcare bulls likely see the drug pricing and tariff overhang from the administration as mostly priced in — plus any softening on Medicare/Medicaid rhetoric would be rocket fuel.

On the flip side, big money is quietly hedging or selling Technology, Consumer Discretionary, and — most strikingly — Materials, where the put activity is off the charts, suggesting smart money thinks the tariff regime and trade war escalation are about to hurt commodity-linked and China-exposed names badly, while the consumer is running out of gas.

The tell nobody's talking about: high-yield credit (HYG) is flashing serious warning signs with spreads widening, meaning bond traders are sniffing out corporate stress even as the S&P holds up — that's the classic setup where stocks are the last to figure out something's wrong.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.91/100
SMCI is the leading AI server integrator, riding secular demand f			
2.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos is a prime beneficiary of rising defense IT and digital mo			
3.	GTLB	GitLab Inc.	8.61/100
GitLab's DevSecOps platform is monetizing AI through GitLab Duo,			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 11–12	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 13–14	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$316.83 ▲ 2.19%** 12M Price Target **\$355.00** 52-Week Range **\$223.78 – \$344.57** Market Cap **\$4.62T**

AAPL: Breaking Out as Tariff Fears Fade, AI Story Builds

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL ripped +2.2% to \$316.83 on heavy volume (50M shares) — it's now up ~4% in two days and sitting near 52-week highs. The move looks like a continuation of the "tariff worst-case is off the table" trade — the market is increasingly betting that Apple's manufacturing diversification (India + Vietnam now ~25% of iPhones) blunts the China risk that had this stock stuck at \$260 earlier this year.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — put/call at 0.48 (well below 1.0 means way more upside bets than downside), and unusual call buying at \$315/\$317.50/\$320 strikes expiring this month tells you traders are positioning for MORE upside into September, not taking profits.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what this move actually means: AAPL is behaving like a stock that's transitioning from "tariff victim" back to "quality compounder." The fact that it's breaking out even as broader tech is mixed (Comm Services only +0.76%, and the news cycle is dominated by NVDA and SpaceX chatter) tells you real money is rotating INTO Apple specifically, not just chasing tech beta. The insider sale from the General Counsel is a nothing-burger — 1,439 shares is a routine tax event, not a signal. What matters more: institutions own 66.5% and BlackRock/Vanguard aren't selling — that's the "smart, slow money" quietly staying long. Watch for the stock to consolidate around \$315-320 before its next leg; if it holds above \$310 on any macro wobble, the technical setup points to \$340+ into the iPhone 18 launch cycle.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is the Section 232 semiconductor tariff review the Trump administration has been dangling — if enacted at the rumored 25% on chip imports, it hits Apple's cost structure directly since TSMC-made A-series and M-series chips are the guts of every device. Counterbalancing that: Apple's \$600B US manufacturing commitment announced earlier this year appears to have bought them political goodwill, and there's growing chatter about an "American-made tech" exemption framework that would carve out companies with domestic investment pledges. Also watch the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement — Brussels is pushing Apple to open up the App Store further, and every concession chips away at Services margin (which is where the real profit growth is).

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$316.83
12M Price Target	\$355.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.0%
Market Cap	\$4.62T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.45
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	42.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



AAPL — Apple Inc. | August 20, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$335.00	\$322.00	\$300.00
6 Months	\$360.00	\$335.00	\$285.00
1 Year	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$270.00
2 Years	\$460.00	\$385.00	\$260.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.51% today, +4.30% for the week) is on fire — likely on drug pricing clarity and biotech M&A chatter. Consumer Discretionary (+1.92%) is strong which is a tell for AAPL since Apple straddles tech and consumer.

COOLING OFF: Pure-play communications and traditional tech ETFs are lagging the tape — money isn't chasing tech beta broadly, it's being selective.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating into quality mega-caps with earnings visibility and away from speculative AI names — that's why AAPL is outperforming even as NVDA gets debated ("too cheap?" per the Yahoo headline signals nervousness). Investors want the AI story WITHOUT the volatility.

RELATED PLAY: If Apple's cycle plays out, the semiconductor supply chain wins too — TSMC (TSM) and Broadcom (AVGO) are the direct beneficiaries. Apple Services strength also lifts payment infrastructure and ad-tech peers.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Same "quality mega-cap with AI optionality" trade — investors want AI exposure without startup risk.
- META (Meta Platforms): Ad-driven cash flow story + AI narrative, running similar playbook to AAPL right now.

AAPL CONTEXT: AAPL is LEADING mega-cap tech this week, which is unusual — it typically lags NVDA/META on AI enthusiasm days. That leadership rotation is meaningful: it says the market has re-rated Apple from "tariff casualty" to "AI beneficiary," and that narrative shift usually has legs of 2-3 quarters, not days.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-7% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$305-310 on pullbacks; add aggressively under \$295

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: iPhone unit sales decline >8% YoY, or a full China export ban on advanced chips flowing back at Apple

Hedging: Long-dated puts 10% out of the money, or pair with a short on a China-exposed hardware peer

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$175.19 ▲ 2.13%	12M Price Target \$185.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$420.99B
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PLTR: AI Demand Real, But Valuation Getting Silly

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock bounced +2.13% to \$175 after three days of drifting lower — the catalyst appears to be the Mercury Systems (MRCY) partnership headline plus another "enterprise AI demand is booming" story. Translation: the market keeps finding fresh reasons to bid this thing up whenever it dips, which tells you sentiment is still white-hot.
- BUT — Director Alexander Moore dumped ~\$2.8M worth of stock on Monday across four tranches. Insider selling into strength isn't automatically bearish (they're rich on paper and taking chips off), but "cluster selling" with zero insider buys is worth noting when you're paying this multiple.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- If Congress trims federal software spending in the fall budget fight — even a headline scare, not an actual cut — PLTR gets hit disproportionately because so much of the story is government-AI expansion
- The valuation itself IS the risk — at 85x sales, this stock doesn't need bad news to drop 30%, it just needs "meh" news; one soft earnings guide and you're looking at \$130 fast
- The non-obvious risk: commercial AI competition is heating up from Microsoft (Copilot for Enterprise) and Databricks — if PLTR's commercial growth rate decelerates from 40%+ to 25%, the whole "we're not just a defense company" narrative cracks

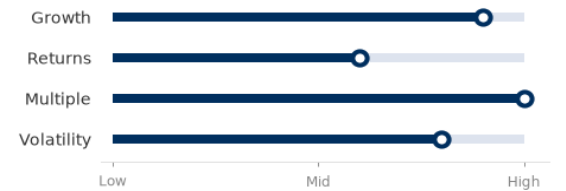
IN THE NEWS

- Is Mercury Systems (MRCY)'s Partnership With Palantir Technologies (PLTR) the Catalyst for...** Insider Monkey · 2026-08-20 12:03
- Prediction: This Will Be Palantir's Stock Price at the End of 2026** Motley Fool · 2026-08-20 10:40
- The Dealmaking 3: Madden's AI Persona Engine, Boehly's \$75B AI Bet & Pac-12 Free on YouTub...** CorpGov.com · 2026-08-19 22:17
- Software Companies' Second-Quarter Beat Rate Accelerates Sequentially, RBC Says** MT Newswires · 2026-08-19 20:34
- Is Palantir Technologies (PLTR) Overvalued As Revenue Growth And 2026 Outlook Jump?** Simply Wall St. · 2026-08-19 18:12

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$175.19
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+5.6%
Market Cap	\$420.99B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.68
FY2027E EPS	\$0.92
Fwd P/E	257.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$195.00	\$178.00	\$158.00
6 Months	\$225.00	\$185.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$260.00	\$190.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$220.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$75.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.51% today) is ripping — likely on drug pricing clarity and the recent Medicare AI-diagnostics reimbursement rules. Consumer Discretionary strength suggests risk-on tape, which supports high-multiple names like PLTR.

COOLING OFF: Tech isn't in the top movers today, which is telling — PLTR is up on stock-specific news, not sector wind. That's a sign the AI trade is getting more selective.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from broad tech into specific AI winners and defensives — PLTR sits in a weird sweet spot as both a defense name AND an AI momentum name, which is why it keeps bouncing.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe in the government AI thesis, the picks-and-shovels names — data center power (VST, CEG) and defense-tech (MRCY, KTOS, AVAV) — offer similar exposure at way less demanding multiples.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MRCY (Mercury Systems): Directly benefiting from the PLTR partnership news — the hardware-software integration story just got real
- ANET (Arista Networks): Data center backbone play, riding the same AI-infrastructure spending wave

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is leading its peer group in terms of narrative and multiple — but that's a double-edged sword. When you're the "best-in-class" story, you get the highest multiple AND the biggest air-pocket when sentiment shifts. It's not lagging; it's just extended.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, I don't love the price. If I already own it I'm not selling; if I don't own it I'm not chasing here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% max — the story is great but the volatility is real, and at this multiple a 30% drawdown is a Tuesday

ENTRY POINTS: Wait for pullbacks to \$150-160, which is where the 50-day moving average sits. If you get a market-wide fear day, you might see \$135 — that's where I back up the truck

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is the FY27 defense budget confirming AI spending growth, plus a couple more quarters of 40%+ commercial growth

WHEN TO BAIL: Two consecutive quarters of commercial growth below 30%, OR a major DoD contract loss, OR insider selling accelerates from a trickle to a flood

HEDGING: If you have a big position, buy 6-month puts about 15% below the current price — think of it as insurance; you're paying maybe 5% of your position value to cap your downside if this thing rolls over

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$265.84 ▲ 2.46%	12M Price Target \$310.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20	Market Cap \$2.87T
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AMZN: Bounces Back as Walmart Stumble Highlights Amazon's Edge

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN popped 2.46% to \$265.84 while Walmart got hammered on weak US sales and soft guidance — the market is basically saying "if the biggest brick-and-mortar retailer is struggling, Amazon's e-commerce dominance looks even more valuable." That's a share-shift story: consumers pulling back means they're being pickier, and Prime + price + speed wins that battle.
- Prime Air (drone delivery) getting expansion headlines — small news today, but it signals Amazon is moving on the last-mile cost problem, which is the single biggest lever for retail margins.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Walmart miss is more important than it looks. When the largest US retailer guides down, it usually means the consumer is weakening — but AMZN went UP on that news, which tells you the market thinks Amazon TAKES share in a soft economy (cheaper, faster, subscription-locked customers). Meanwhile, the Barron's piece on the "AI bond bonanza" is a yellow flag for the whole hyperscaler group — Amazon, Microsoft, Google are all borrowing heavily to fund data center buildouts, and if interest rates stay elevated, that debt gets expensive. Watch for AWS growth to justify the capex — if it re-accelerates above 20%, the stock breaks \$287 (52-week high); if it stalls, the bond overhang becomes the story.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to track: (1) The FTC's antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding — a settlement or narrow ruling is the bull case, a forced separation of AWS or the marketplace is the tail risk (unlikely near-term but real). (2) Tariff policy — the administration's ongoing tariff posture with China directly hits Amazon's third-party sellers (60%+ of units sold), which could pressure marketplace fees or shift more volume to Amazon's own private label (actually margin-accretive). Also worth watching: FAA drone delivery rules — any loosening is a direct Prime Air tailwind, and there's bipartisan support for accelerating US drone regulations to compete with China.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

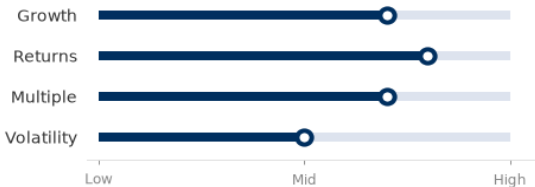
At ~39x forward earnings, you're paying \$39 for every \$1 of expected profit — that's premium to the S&P (~22x) but reasonable for a company with AWS (a ~35% margin business) growing ~18%. The key is EV/EBITDA around 17.5x, which is actually cheaper than Microsoft (~22x) despite similar AI exposure — so relative to Big Tech peers, Amazon looks fairly priced, not expensive. Justified if AWS growth holds; stretched if consumer weakness bleeds into retail margins.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$265.84
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.6%
Market Cap	\$2.87T
FY2026E Revenue	\$512M
FY2027E Revenue	\$572M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.10
Fwd P/E	38.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$272.00	\$250.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$310.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$350.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.51% today, +4.30% week) — likely reflecting policy tailwinds or defensive rotation as investors get nervous about consumer names. Consumer Discretionary also up despite Walmart, because AMZN is dragging the sector.

COOLING OFF: Traditional retail is clearly cooling — Walmart's guide-down is the tell. Anything without an AI or e-commerce moat is losing bid.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from brick-and-mortar retail INTO Amazon and defensive healthcare — that's a "late cycle" pattern where investors want winners-take-all businesses.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AMZN drone/logistics thesis, look at industrial REITs that lease warehouse space and last-mile logistics infrastructure — they benefit from every package Amazon ships.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- **COST (Costco):** Winning the "consumer trades down but stays loyal" theme — membership model is Amazon Prime's closest analog.
- **MELI (MercadoLibre):** Latin America e-commerce, growing faster than AMZN with less regulatory heat.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is at 77% of its 52-week range and outperformed retail peers today — that's leadership behavior, not laggard behavior. The setup favors a breakout attempt toward \$287 if broader tape holds.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Amazon is one of the few names where you get retail dominance, cloud/AI leadership, and optionality (drones, ads, healthcare) in one ticker. Not pounding the table because valuation isn't cheap and there's a real AI-capex overhang.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% — core holding size. The business is durable enough to be a foundation, but I'd leave room to add on dips.

ENTRY POINTS: The \$258-262 zone held twice this week — that's your accumulation area. Anything under \$250 is a gift.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalyst: Q3 earnings (AWS growth number is THE metric), plus any FTC resolution.

WHEN TO BAIL: AWS growth slipping below 15%, or a forced structural remedy from the FTC case. Also, if Herrington-style insider selling accelerates into a cluster, reassess.

HEDGING: Buy a small amount of downside protection (puts) around earnings — costs maybe 1-2% of your position but caps the tail risk if guidance disappoints. Or pair-trade by shorting a weaker retailer.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$139.65 ▼ 2.57%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.84T
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SPCX: Space ETF Cools as SpaceX Unlock Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX dropped 2.6% today and is down about 4.5% from Monday's high — mostly because SpaceX (which SPCX has heavy indirect exposure to via holdings like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and Planet Labs) is facing a "share unlock" — meaning insiders and early investors are finally allowed to sell shares they've been holding, which floods the market with supply and pushes prices down.
- Bonus catalyst: China hit a rocket milestone, which spooked investors about US space dominance — even though more competition usually means MORE government spending on space, not less. The market's reacting emotionally in the short term.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the space sector had a monster run (SPCX hit \$225 earlier this year), and now we're in a healthy pullback where the froth comes off. The SpaceX share unlock is a technical event, not a fundamental one — it doesn't change the underlying business, but it does mean sellers outnumber buyers for a few weeks. More importantly, the Starlink 11,000 satellite milestone is actually bullish for the ecosystem — every satellite launched requires ground stations, spectrum, insurance, and components, and SPCX holds many of those "picks and shovels" names. The China angle cuts both ways: near-term fear, but medium-term it likely forces Congress to open the checkbook wider on Space Force and NASA.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

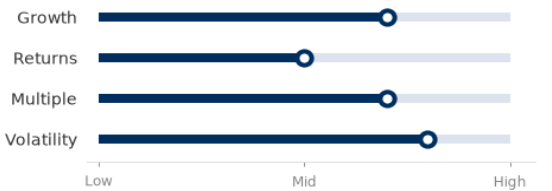
The big thing to watch is the FY2027 defense authorization working through Congress right now — Space Force is expected to get a ~\$35B budget request (up from ~\$29B), and if that clears, it's a direct tailwind for SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab, L3Harris, and Iridium that hold DoD contracts. There's also an active FCC proceeding on spectrum allocation for satellite broadband — if the FCC sides with satellite operators over terrestrial telecoms, Starlink competitors in SPCX (like Iridium and Viasat) get a real boost. Wildcard: any Trump executive order pushing "Golden Dome" missile defense would be jet fuel for the space defense names in this ETF.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

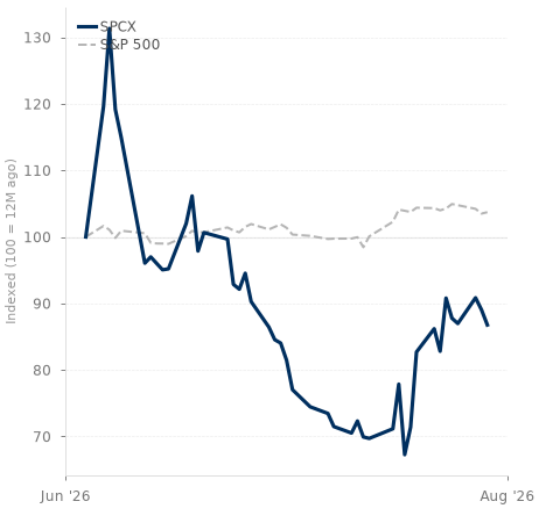
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$139.65
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.0%
Market Cap	\$1.84T
FY2026E Revenue	\$0K
FY2027E Revenue	\$0K
FY2026E EPS	\$0.00
FY2027E EPS	\$0.00
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$152.00	\$142.00	\$130.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$125.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$190.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$275.00	\$130.00
10 Years	\$700.00	\$450.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5%) is ripping — likely on positive drug pricing news or Medicare reimbursement clarity. Consumer Discretionary (+1.9%) suggests risk-on for consumer spending, which is broadly bullish for markets.

COOLING OFF: Tech and space-adjacent names are cooling as the SpaceX unlock creates sector-wide indigestion. Money is rotating OUT of high-multiple growth into defensive value.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic late-summer rotation into healthcare and staples — investors are getting defensive ahead of September (historically the worst month for stocks). Space stocks get caught in this crossfire even though fundamentals are fine.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the space thesis but want less volatility, look at defense primes like LMT (Lockheed) or NOC (Northrop Grumman) — they benefit from the same Space Force budget growth but with dividends and lower beta.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning share from SpaceX in small-satellite launch and getting DoD contracts — best pure-play growth story in the ETF.
- IRDM (Iridium): Steady cash flow from satellite communications plus DoD contracts — the "boring winner" of the space theme.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its individual top holdings because the ETF structure smooths out both the upside AND downside. When space is hot, single names outperform SPCX; when it's cooling like now, SPCX holds up better than the volatile names. That tells me SPCX is best used as a "sleep at night" way to own the theme without picking winners.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term space thesis but the near-term technicals (SpaceX unlock, seasonal weakness) argue for patience.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is a thematic bet, not a core holding. Keep it small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$130-135 to add — that's near the pre-summer breakout level and would represent a full digestion of the unlock. Buying here at \$139 isn't wrong, just not optimal.

TIME HORIZON: 12-36 months — the real catalyst is the FY2027 defense budget passing (late 2026/early 2027) plus continued commercial space contract wins.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Space Force budget gets cut more than 15% OR if two of the top 5 holdings issue guidance cuts within a quarter, the thesis is broken — get out.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge: keep 20-30% of your intended position in cash to average down if it hits \$125. If you want a real hedge, pair it with a boring dividend ETF like SCHD — when growth sells off, dividend names typically catch a bid.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$95.77 ▲ 4.63%	12M Price Target \$115.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$86.11B
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HOOD: Crypto Rally + Clarity Act Push = Direct Tailwind

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD popped 4.6% on massive volume (25M shares vs ~14M average) — the driver is clearly Trump's White House crypto meeting yesterday pushing the Clarity Act, with Bitcoin blasting past \$71K. HOOD is one of the cleanest ways to play retail crypto trading in a regulated US stock, so when crypto rips + regulation gets friendlier, HOOD gets a double lift.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — 152K calls vs 41K puts (put/call ratio of 0.27 is very bullish, means traders are betting way more on upside than downside), with a big \$98 call buyer loading up 9,900 contracts. Someone with money is positioning for more upside near-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Clarity Act (which would give the CFTC clear jurisdiction over most crypto and stop the SEC's enforcement-by-lawsuit approach) is the single biggest regulatory catalyst HOOD has had in years. If it passes, HOOD can legally expand its crypto product lineup — more tokens, staking, potentially derivatives — without the constant threat of being sued for offering "unregistered securities." That's not just a sentiment win, it's a real revenue unlock because crypto is already HOOD's highest-margin business. The market is starting to price this in, but if the bill actually clears the Senate this fall, there's another leg up from here — this rally may be early innings, not late.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The Clarity Act (formally the Financial Innovation and Technology for the 21st Century Act) is the one to watch — it passed the House with bipartisan support and Trump is actively lobbying for Senate passage. If it clears, HOOD gets to expand crypto offerings dramatically; if it stalls, we go back to the SEC playing whack-a-mole. Also keep an eye on the PFOF (payment for order flow — how HOOD makes money routing your trades to market makers) debate — the current SEC under Trump has backed off the Gensler-era threats to ban it, which is a huge quiet tailwind that people forget about.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

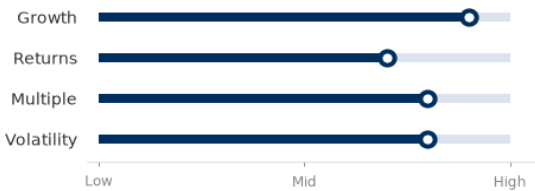
At \$86B market cap and roughly 20x forward revenue, HOOD is not cheap — you're paying \$20 for every \$1 of sales, versus a legacy broker like Schwab at more like \$5. But HOOD is growing revenue 40%+ and crypto is a call option on regulation. The multiple is justified IF the Clarity Act passes and crypto volumes stay elevated; if either breaks, this stock is expensive fast.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$95.77
12M Price Target	\$115.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.1%
Market Cap	\$86.11B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,300M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.45
Fwd P/E	51.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$108.00	\$100.00	\$88.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$110.00	\$80.00
1 Year	\$155.00	\$115.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$145.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$200.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Crypto-adjacent financials (COIN, HOOD, MSTR, Circle) on the Clarity Act push — this is direct policy tailwind. Healthcare also ripping today (+3.5%) on separate catalysts.

COOLING OFF: Tech mega-caps look tired here — money is rotating out of "safe" AI names into higher-beta stuff like crypto plays now that regulatory risk is fading.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly moving into risk-on, regulation-sensitive names as Washington signals crypto-friendly policy. That's a straight-line benefit for HOOD's business model.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD keeps running on crypto tailwinds, the "picks and shovels" plays — CME (crypto futures), Coinbase (custody), and even the stablecoin issuers like Circle — all benefit from the same regulatory clarity.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Direct beneficiary of Clarity Act — they've been waiting years for regulatory clarity to launch new products.
- MSTR (Strategy, formerly MicroStrategy): Basically a leveraged Bitcoin bet, ripping alongside BTC price.
- CRCL (Circle): Stablecoin issuer riding the same regulatory-clarity wave.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is participating in the rally but not leading it — COIN and MSTR are more direct crypto plays. That's actually good news: it means HOOD has room to catch up if crypto momentum sustains, because it's a more diversified business that shouldn't be as volatile down if crypto rolls over.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — The setup is unusually clean: bullish policy catalyst, strong options flow, high institutional ownership (80%), and a business that's actually profitable now. I'm not pounding the table because the stock is up huge YTD and near the middle of its 52-week range with room to fall on macro shocks.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but the volatility is legit; this thing can move 5% on any given day.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$88-92, which is where the recent trading range support sits. Don't chase above \$100 today.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — main catalyst is Clarity Act Senate vote (fall 2026) and Q3/Q4 crypto trading volumes.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Bitcoin breaks below \$55K decisively, or if the Clarity Act gets killed in Senate committee, or if management guides down crypto revenue on the next earnings call.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — keep some cash on the sidelines so you can buy more on a 15% pullback. Fancier version: own a little bit of a short-Bitcoin ETF or buy protective puts on HOOD 20% out-of-the-money if you want insurance against a crypto crash.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Hold

\$546.03 ▲ 0.43%

12M Price Target
\$620.00

52-Week Range
\$520.26 – \$790.80

Market Cap
\$1.39T

META: FTC Trial Overhang Meets AI Spending Anxiety

WHAT HAPPENED

- META just dropped ~8% in a week and is sitting at the very bottom of its 52-week range (10% of range = basically the floor). The catalyst is that Bloomberg headline about the FTC antitrust trial — regulators are pushing to unwind the Instagram/WhatsApp acquisitions, and the market is starting to price in the "what if they actually lose" scenario.
- Second hit: Barron's is warning about the "AI bond bonanza" — meaning hyperscalers like META are borrowing massive amounts to fund AI data centers, and investors are getting nervous the returns won't justify the spend. On top of that, META is now reportedly a big Azure customer, which is weird (they usually build their own) and suggests their internal AI compute isn't keeping up.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the tape is telling you: options flow is screaming bearish (put/call ratio of 0.40 sounds bullish, but the unusual activity is all in out-of-the-money puts at \$630-660 — meaning big money is buying insurance against further downside, not betting on upside). Dan Loeb dumping his stake reinforces that smart money is de-risking ahead of the trial ruling. The real question isn't whether META's business is good — it's phenomenal, ~40% operating margins — it's whether the FTC forces them to spin off Instagram, which would be a trillion-dollar structural change. Until that trial resolves, expect the stock to trade in a \$520-600 range with headline risk on both sides.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FTC antitrust trial is THE story — a loss could force divestiture of Instagram and/or WhatsApp, which analysts estimate account for 30-50% of META's ad revenue. Separately, the Trump administration's stance on Big Tech has been schizophrenic: friendly on AI deregulation and China competition (tailwind), hostile on content moderation and Section 230 reform (headwind). Watch for any signal from the White House on whether they'll pressure the FTC to settle — Trump and Zuckerberg have had a public thaw, and a settlement instead of breakup would send this stock ripping 15%+ overnight.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~20x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$20 for every \$1 of profit META will earn next year — the stock is actually cheap for a company growing revenue 15%+ with best-in-class margins. Compare to GOOGL at ~22x and MSFT at ~30x. The discount is entirely the antitrust overhang; strip that out and this is a \$700+ stock. Translation: you're being paid to take regulatory risk.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

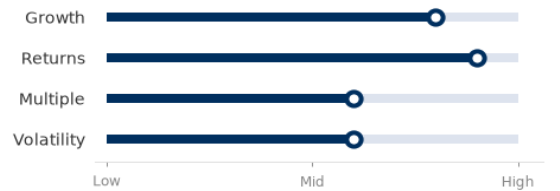
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-20 13:25 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$546.03
12M Price Target	\$620.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.5%
Market Cap	\$1.39T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$26.50
FY2027E EPS	\$30.20
Fwd P/E	20.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$600.00	\$560.00	\$510.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$610.00	\$470.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$620.00	\$420.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$380.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$350.00
10 Years	\$1800.00	\$1100.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5% today) is ripping — likely on drug pricing clarity and defensive rotation. Consumer Discretionary strong on resilient consumer data.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (META's sector) is barely up 0.76% — lagging badly, which tells you the AI-trade nervousness is concentrated here.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of mega-cap tech/AI names and INTO defensives (healthcare, staples) — classic late-cycle behavior when investors get nervous about valuations. That's a headwind for META until sentiment flips.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI capex fears are overblown, the picks-and-shovels names (NVDA, data center REITs like EQIX, and power utilities like VST) benefit from META's spending regardless of what META's own stock does.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Holding up better because their antitrust issues are already priced in and Gemini traction is real
- NFLX (Netflix): No AI capex burden, pure content play — money is hiding here within Comm Services

META CONTEXT: META is lagging its mega-cap peers hard right now — down at 10% of its 52-week range while GOOGL and MSFT are closer to highs. That relative weakness is entirely trial-driven, and it means when/if the overhang lifts, META has the most catch-up room in the group.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — the business is elite and the valuation is reasonable, but I can't pound the table with a trial verdict hanging over it.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — big enough to matter if it works, small enough that a bad ruling doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: Add in the \$520-535 zone (near 52-week low). If it breaks \$520 on trial news, wait for it to stabilize before adding — don't catch a falling knife.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is FTC trial resolution, which likely comes in the first half of 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If the court orders divestiture of Instagram, get out same day and reassess. Also bail if ad revenue growth drops below 10% year-over-year — that's the sign the core business is cracking.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge: buy a put option expiring after the trial ruling — think of it as insurance that pays out if the stock crashes. Costs maybe 3-4% of your position but caps your downside. Alternative: pair it with a smaller short in GOOGL so you're betting on META specifically vs. the sector.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Hold	\$937.11 ▼ 0.39%	12M Price Target \$1050.00	52-Week Range \$114.25 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: Memory Mania Cools After Wild Run to \$1,000+

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is digesting a massive move — hit \$1,011 on Aug 17 then dropped ~7% in two sessions to \$937. This isn't news-driven; it's profit-taking after a monster run. The Druckenmiller headline (billionaire investor who famously sold Nvidia too early) hints that even smart money is questioning whether the memory trade is getting late-innings.
- Barron's flagged that Micron is NOT joining the memory buyback party "yet" — meaning while competitors like SK Hynix and Samsung return cash to shareholders, Micron is hoarding it for capex. That's a tell: management sees more runway to invest in HBM capacity than to prop up the stock.

WHY IT MATTERS

The pullback isn't a red flag — it's what happens when a stock triples in six months and needs to breathe. But here's the bigger signal: Cramer is pounding the table, retail is piling in via unusual call activity (\$19M notional on \$930 calls), and Druckenmiller is reportedly out. When the smart money exits and the loud money enters, you're usually in the late innings of the trade — not the end, but past the easy money. The insider sales on Aug 10 at ~\$202 (which appears to be a stock-split-adjusted figure, or possibly restricted stock vesting given the "OTHER" transaction type) aren't panic selling but they're also not confidence signals. Bottom line: the fundamental story (HBM shortage, AI capex tsunami) is still intact, but the risk/reward isn't as juicy as it was at \$300.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

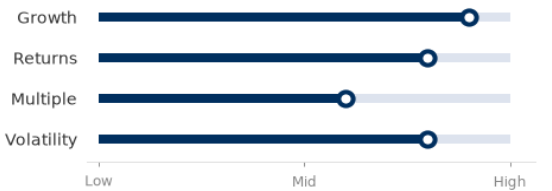
Micron is the biggest single beneficiary of the CHIPS and Science Act — they've committed \$100B+ to US fabs in New York and Idaho, with billions in federal grants and tax credits already flowing. Watch two things: (1) any Congressional attempt to renegotiate or claw back CHIPS Act awards (there's been chatter about tying disbursements to stricter workforce/wage requirements) — that would spook the stock; (2) tariff policy on Chinese memory makers like CXMT (China's rising DRAM competitor). The current administration's export controls on advanced memory to China are effectively a moat around Micron's business — any softening in that stance during trade negotiations would be a real headwind, while further tightening is pure tailwind.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$937.11
12M Price Target	\$1050.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.0%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$52,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$68,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$42.50
FY2027E EPS	\$58.00
Fwd P/E	22.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$950.00	\$850.00
6 Months	\$1300.00	\$1050.00	\$780.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1100.00	\$700.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1250.00	\$600.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1500.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2000.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5% today, +4.3% on the week) is ripping — likely a rotation trade as investors take profits from red-hot tech/semis and look for laggards. Consumer Discretionary also firm as rate-cut expectations build.

COOLING OFF: Semis aren't in the top movers today — that's notable. After leading all year, chips are taking a breather as money rotates. Not a crisis, just profit-taking.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving OUT of the AI/semi trade and INTO defensives (healthcare, staples) — classic late-cycle behavior. If this rotation continues for more than a week, MU could see another leg down before finding support.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the memory thesis but want less crowded exposure, look at the memory equipment names — Lam Research (LRCX) and Applied Materials (AMAT) — they sell picks and shovels to Micron and Samsung both, and haven't run as hard.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the king of the AI trade — every Micron HBM chip ends up on a Nvidia GPU, so they're joined at the hip.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon for hyperscalers keeps winning; less cyclical than pure memory.

MU CONTEXT: Micron has been LEADING the semi group in 2026 (up 300% first half per the Druckenmiller article), but is now lagging on the pullback — which is normal for the highest-beta name in a group. The tell will be whether it bounces off \$900 or breaks lower; a break of \$880 would suggest the rotation is real and there's more downside.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio (trim if you rode it up)

Entry Points: \$850-880 on pullbacks; don't chase above \$1000

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing rolls over, hyperscaler capex cuts, or CHIPS Act funding gets clawed back

Hedging: Pair with a short on a smaller memory name or buy SOX puts to protect against a sector-wide correction

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Buy **\$351.12 ▲ 4.23%** 12M Price Target **\$425.00** 52-Week Range **\$297.38 – \$498.83**

Market Cap
\$1.39T

TSLA: Cybercab Inflection Point Meets Robotaxi Reality Check

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA popped 4.2% yesterday and it's basically one story: Barron's and JPMorgan both flagged the Cybercab (Tesla's robotaxi) rollout as a "major inflection point," and JPM is buying management's confidence on scaling. Translation: Wall Street is starting to price in the robotaxi as a real business, not a slide deck.
- The options flow is screaming bullish — huge call buying at \$340, \$345, and \$350 strikes expiring this week (calls = bets the stock goes up). Someone with real money is betting on more upside near-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to actually think about: TSLA is only at 27% of its 52-week range, meaning it's been beaten up all year — so this pop is more "sentiment shift" than "breakout." The Cybercab narrative matters because it's how Tesla justifies its trillion-dollar valuation despite car sales being flat-to-down; if investors buy the robotaxi story, the stock can trade like an AI/software company (high multiple) instead of a car company (low multiple). But the flip side: management has cried wolf on autonomy for a decade, so every delay from here hits harder. FSD v15 being called a "step-change" by JPM is the tell — if real-world data confirms it over the next few months, this stock has room to run; if it disappoints, the air comes out fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The elephant in the room: the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit officially ended in September 2025 under the Trump administration's tax bill, and that's been a headwind on Tesla's US deliveries all year — it's why the stock is stuck near the bottom of its range. The offset is that the same administration has been friendlier on autonomous vehicle regulation, with NHTSA under Trump signaling a lighter touch on FSD/robotaxi rules — that's a direct tailwind for Cybercab commercialization. Also watch China tariff talks: Tesla's Shanghai gigafactory is exposed both ways (exports to Europe, component sourcing), so any escalation this fall hits margins.

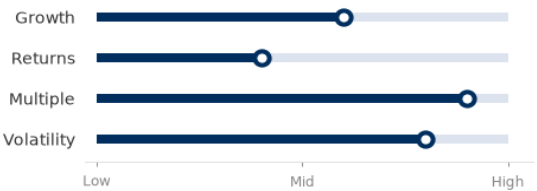
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$1.39T market cap, TSLA trades around 12x sales and ~160x forward earnings — investors are paying \$160 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year, versus Toyota at ~10x and Ford at ~7x. That's not a car company multiple; that's an "I believe in robotaxis and Optimus robots" multiple. Justifiable ONLY if Cybercab actually scales — otherwise this is a \$200 stock wearing a \$350 costume.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$351.12
12M Price Target	\$425.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.0%
Market Cap	\$1.39T
FY2026E Revenue	\$112M
FY2027E Revenue	\$138M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.40
Fwd P/E	163.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$385.00	\$360.00	\$320.00
6 Months	\$460.00	\$400.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$550.00	\$425.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$700.00	\$480.00	\$230.00
5 Years	\$1100.00	\$650.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$1800.00	\$900.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5% today) is ripping on rate-cut expectations and M&A chatter. Consumer Discretionary (+1.9%) is catching a bid partly because of TSLA itself — it's a huge weight in that ETF.

COOLING OFF: Nothing majorly bleeding today, but Nasdaq futures were soft premarket suggesting mega-cap tech is taking a breather after a strong run.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of pure AI/semis (TSM capacity concerns are in the news) and into "AI-adjacent" plays like TSLA where the AI story is bundled with a real product. That's the setup that helps TSLA specifically.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the autonomy story, the picks-and-shovels are semiconductor names like NVDA (Tesla uses their chips for training) and LiDAR/sensor companies. Uber (UBER) is also interesting — either they partner with Tesla on Cybercab (bullish) or Cybercab eats their lunch (bearish).

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RIVN (Rivian): catching a bid on speculation they benefit from any AV regulatory framework Tesla helps establish
- NVDA (Nvidia): still the default winner anytime "AI infrastructure" is in the headlines

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is lagging its own potential — at 27% of 52-week range while the Nasdaq is near highs, it's been the mega-cap laggard. That's actually bullish setup-wise: if the Cybercab narrative sticks, there's a lot of catch-up room. But it also means the market has been skeptical for a reason, so you need real proof points.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Cautiously optimistic. The setup is interesting (beaten-up stock + real catalyst on deck), but I'm not pounding the table because Tesla has broken this pattern before.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio. Small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your year, big enough that a Cybercab-driven rip actually matters.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add on pullbacks to \$320-335 than chase this 4% pop. TSLA gives you dips constantly — be patient.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst you're waiting for is Cybercab commercial launch data and Q4 2026 delivery numbers.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Cybercab gets pushed to late 2027, or if FSD v15 shows any serious safety issues in real-world data, exit. Also bail if the stock breaks below \$290 (52-week low) — that's the market telling you the thesis is broken.

HEDGING: Buy put options as insurance (they pay you if the stock drops) — TSLA moves so violently that cheap out-of-the-money puts often pay off. Or just pair with a stable auto name like Toyota to hedge sector risk.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$217.56 ▼ 0.99%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.27T
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NVDA: Cooling Into Earnings, But AI Trade Still Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down about 3.5% over the last three sessions heading into earnings — this is classic "de-risking" behavior, meaning big investors trim positions before a major event so they're not caught offside if the report disappoints. Not a fundamental red flag on its own.
- Options market is flashing caution: put/call ratio at 0.52 sounds bullish on the surface, but the unusual activity is heavy on near-the-money puts at \$217.50 (50k contracts, 3.6x normal open interest) — someone big is paying up for downside protection into the print.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the tape is telling you: NVDA earnings are the single biggest event for the entire market this month, and the pullback from \$225 to \$217 suggests smart money is protecting gains rather than betting against the story. The OpenAI "growth disappoints" headline from Monday is doing some damage by association — if the biggest AI customer is slowing, the market worries the chip orders slow too. But that logic is shakier than it looks: hyperscaler capex (Microsoft, Meta, Google, Amazon spending on data centers) is still guided up double-digits, and those four alone are ~40% of NVDA's revenue. The setup into the print is a coiled spring — beat and raise sends this to \$240+, in-line with cautious China commentary probably means a dip to \$205 before it recovers.

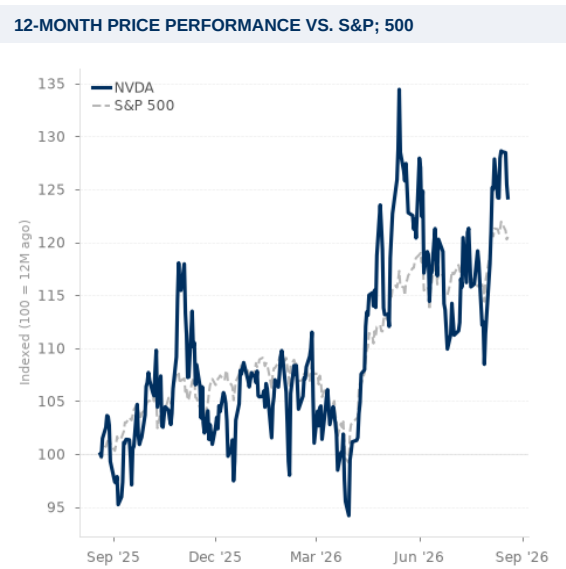
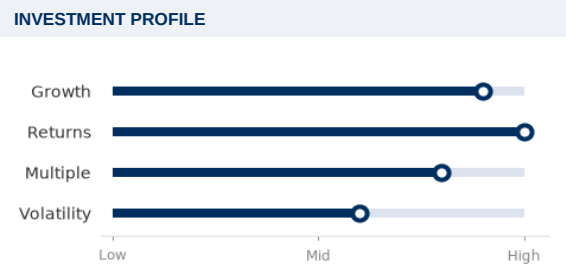
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is the Trump administration's China chip export framework — the current deal lets NVDA sell H20 chips to China in exchange for a 15% revenue cut to the U.S. government, which is unprecedented and legally messy. If Congress moves to codify or block this arrangement (there's bipartisan noise on both sides), it directly hits ~10-12% of NVDA's revenue. Also watch the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and any executive orders on AI infrastructure permitting — faster data center approvals = faster GPU orders = tailwind. Net-net: the regulatory environment is a mixed bag, but the administration clearly views AI dominance as a national priority, which is structurally bullish.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$217, NVDA trades around 45x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$45 today for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year. That's expensive vs the S&P 500 at ~22x, but cheap for a company still growing revenue 40%+ with 75% gross margins (they keep 75 cents of every dollar in sales before overhead). The stock is basically priced for continued dominance — any crack in that narrative and the multiple compresses fast, but any beat justifies the current price easily.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$217.56
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.5%
Market Cap	\$5.27T
FY2027E Revenue	\$215M
FY2028E Revenue	\$275M
FY2027E EPS	\$4.85
FY2028E EPS	\$6.30
Fwd P/E	44.9x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$245.00	\$225.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$270.00	\$240.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$360.00	\$300.00	\$170.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$380.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$500.00	\$220.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5% today) — rotation into defensives suggests some investors are taking risk off the table ahead of NVDA earnings. Consumer Discretionary also up, hinting at a "soft landing" narrative gaining traction.

COOLING OFF: Tech isn't in the top movers list today, which is telling — money is rotating OUT of tech into more defensive corners ahead of the print. This is short-term positioning, not a trend change.

ROTATION WATCH: The healthcare + staples bid + tech softness combo is classic "de-risking before a catalyst" behavior. If NVDA prints well Wednesday, this reverses violently within 48 hours.

RELATED PLAY: The AI power/infrastructure angle is under-owned — data centers are hitting grid capacity limits, so names like VST (Vistra), CEG (Constellation Energy), and even industrial cooling/electrical (ETN, VRT) benefit whether NVDA has a great quarter or just a good one.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on custom AI chip design wins with hyperscalers — the "if you can't beat 'em, help them build their own" trade.
- VRT (Vertiv): Data center cooling and power — every GPU NVDA ships needs their gear, and they don't have China risk.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA has been consolidating while some peers push higher, which usually means it's the "safe" AI name that's fully discounted and the money is chasing the next-tier beneficiaries. That's actually a bullish setup — when NVDA prints, it reasserts leadership and the whole complex rallies with it.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — The AI capex cycle isn't over, and NVDA still has the best chips, best software (CUDA), and best margins in the industry. Only reason it's not a 9 is China policy uncertainty.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — this is a core holding for anyone bullish on AI, but don't go bigger because a single earnings print or China headline can move it 10% overnight.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add in the \$210-215 zone if we see pre-earnings weakness, and back up the truck under \$200. Chasing above \$230 pre-print is bad risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the real catalyst isn't this earnings, it's the Blackwell Ultra ramp and Rubin architecture reveal in 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If data center revenue growth slows below 30% YoY for two consecutive quarters, or if a full China ban gets reinstated with no offset, the thesis changes.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying a put option 10% below current price expiring after earnings — it's insurance that costs a small premium but protects you if the print disappoints. Or just trim 20% of your position before Wednesday and buy it back after.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$344.72 ▲ 0.15%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$199.43 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.22T
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GOOGL: Custom AI Chip Deal Signals Deeper Moat

WHAT HAPPENED

- The big overnight story: Google struck a warrant-backed custom AI chip deal with Marvell (MRVL popped 9%). Translation — Google is paying Marvell partly in stock warrants (the right to buy MRVL shares later at a set price) to co-design custom AI silicon. Why it matters: this reduces Google's dependence on Nvidia and locks in chip supply, which is the #1 bottleneck in AI right now.
- Barron's is banging the drum about the "AI bond bonanza" — meaning hyperscalers (Google, Meta, MSFT, Amazon) are issuing massive amounts of debt to fund AI capex. That's a double-edged sword: it funds the buildout, but if AI monetization slows, the debt bill still comes due.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Marvell deal is bigger than the headline suggests — it tells you Google is done being a customer and is becoming a chip designer at scale, which structurally lowers their long-term cost of AI compute versus rivals still paying Nvidia's ~70% margins. Combined with the fact that GOOGL sits at 84% of its 52-week range and is barely moving on good news, the setup looks like a stock digesting big gains rather than topping out. The bearish options flow (heavy near-term put buying at \$380/\$390 strikes) is likely institutional hedging into Jackson Hole and end-of-August, not a directional bet — those are out-of-the-money puts being used as insurance. Bottom line: the fundamental story is quietly getting stronger while the stock takes a breather, which is usually when you accumulate, not sell.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

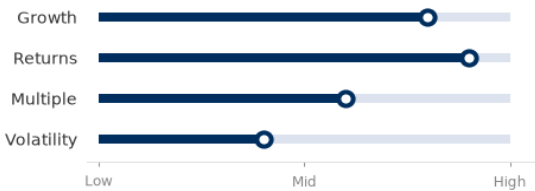
The critical near-term catalyst is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase in the Search monopoly case — the market has largely priced in a "behavioral remedy" (forced data sharing, default search deal restrictions) rather than a structural breakup of Chrome/Android. If the final remedy stays behavioral, that's a relief rally trigger. Separately, the Trump administration's AI executive orders have been notably industry-friendly — pushing federal agencies to adopt US-built AI (helps Google Cloud's government pipeline) and easing export controls on chips to allied nations, which expands GOOGL's TPU addressable market. Watch also for any movement on Section 230 reform in Congress — that's the law that shields YouTube from liability for user content, and any weakening would be a direct headwind.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$344.72
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.7%
Market Cap	\$4.22T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.60
Fwd P/E	35.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5% today) is ripping — likely rate-cut positioning ahead of Jackson Hole plus the Moderna surge reminding people biotech beta exists. Consumer Discretionary strong on resilient consumer data.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (Google's sector) only +0.76% — mega-cap tech is consolidating after a huge run, not breaking down. This is rotation, not rejection.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of pure mega-cap tech and INTO rate-sensitive sectors (healthcare, real estate, staples) as the market prices in September cuts. GOOGL is caught in the crossfire but its AI story is a magnet that limits downside.

RELATED PLAY: The Marvell deal is a tell — custom silicon partners (MRVL, AVGO) are the second-order winners of hyperscaler capex. Also watch data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power infrastructure (VST, CEG) — they get paid regardless of which AI model wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MRVL (Marvell): +9.3% on the Google warrant deal — they just got anointed as a preferred custom AI silicon partner, which analysts say could add \$6+ to EPS over time.
- MRNA (Moderna): Historic surge today driving the whole healthcare tape — reminder that beaten-down names can rip on a single catalyst.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is LAGGING today (+0.15%) versus the broader tape, but it's lagging because it's already up huge YTD and near 52-week highs. This is healthy consolidation, not weakness — the stock is building a base in the \$340s that becomes the launchpad for the next leg if the DOJ ruling lands favorably.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-7% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$335-345 on any market pullback

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Forced breakup ruling in DOJ antitrust remedy, or Search revenue declines 2+ quarters in a row from AI disruption

Hedging: Small put position or pair-trade long GOOGL / short a richer-multiple AI name like a pure-play semi at 40x+ earnings

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy

\$237.27 ▲ 9.85%

12M Price Target
\$285.00

52-Week Range
\$61.44 – \$329.88

Market Cap
\$212.96B

MRVL: Google Chip Deal Rewrites the AI Silicon Story

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL popped almost 10% on news that Google signed a custom AI chip deal that includes warrants (basically Google getting the right to buy MRVL stock at a set price, tying the two companies together financially). GuruFocus estimates this could add \$6.15 to earnings per share — that's massive for a company earning roughly \$2-3 EPS today.
- Wolfe Research reiterated MRVL as their Top Pick in AI semis this morning, adding fuel. Volume was 43M shares — more than double the recent average — meaning big money was chasing this, not just retail.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Google warrant structure is a bigger deal than the headline suggests — it means Google has skin in the game and is effectively locking MRVL in as a long-term custom silicon partner (custom silicon = chips designed for one specific customer's workload, way more profitable than off-the-shelf). This validates the bull thesis that MRVL is the #2 player after Broadcom in the "design chips for hyperscalers" business — which is arguably the most defensible corner of the AI trade. Watch for Amazon and Microsoft to feel pressure to deepen their own MRVL relationships (Amazon's Trainium chips already use MRVL). The stock at \$237 is still ~28% off its 52-week high of \$329, so there's real room to run if this deal is a template for more.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CHIPS Act extension debate is heating up in Washington — the original 2022 law is up for renewal, and there's bipartisan momentum to expand domestic semi manufacturing subsidies, which directly helps MRVL since they're a US-designed chip company outsourcing to TSMC. Bigger picture: the Trump administration's export controls on advanced chips to China are a double-edged sword — MRVL loses some China revenue (roughly 15% of sales), but it also forces US hyperscalers to double down on domestic chip partners like MRVL rather than depend on Asian alternatives. Watch for the Commerce Department's next round of export control updates in September — anything that carves out custom ASIC designs would be a clean tailwind.

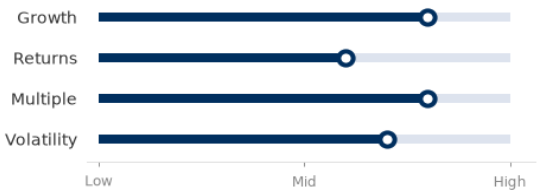
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$213B market cap and ~\$8B in revenue, investors are paying roughly \$26 for every \$1 of sales — that's rich, but Broadcom trades at similar multiples and Nvidia is even higher, so it's in the ballpark for AI silicon. On forward earnings, you're paying about 70x — meaning \$70 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year. That's only justified if the Google-style deals keep coming and EPS actually hits the \$6+ trajectory the warrant math implies.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$237.27
12M Price Target	\$285.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.1%
Market Cap	\$212.96B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,800M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.40
Fwd P/E	69.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$260.00	\$245.00	\$215.00
6 Months	\$300.00	\$270.00	\$200.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$285.00	\$190.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$340.00	\$180.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+3.5% today, likely on the Moderna surge spilling into biotech). AI semis broadly are catching a Wolfe upgrade bid. Anything tied to hyperscaler capex is bid.

COOLING OFF: Tech mega-caps like Meta are wobbling on antitrust trial risk (Bloomberg flagged trillion-dollar liability today) — investors are rotating from platform names into the picks-and-shovels AI infrastructure plays.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing out of "AI application" names and into "AI infrastructure" — that's exactly where MRVL lives. The bet is that infrastructure gets paid first, before app-layer AI monetizes.

RELATED PLAY: If MRVL's custom silicon story keeps winning, watch the memory guys (MU) and advanced packaging plays (AMKR) — those chips need HBM memory and sophisticated packaging to work.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): The original custom AI silicon king — MRVL is basically running the Broadcom playbook, and AVGO keeps grinding higher as hyperscaler orders stack up.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the GPU standard, benefits from every dollar of AI capex regardless of who wins the custom chip race.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL was lagging AVGO badly through the first half of 2026, trading like the "cheaper AI semi" — today's move is the market repricing MRVL closer to peer multiples. If Google's warrant deal is a signal that MRVL has real pricing power, this catch-up trade has legs.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — the Google warrant is a legitimate business validation, not just hype, and options flow (put/call at 0.36 means way more bulls than bears) confirms smart money is leaning in.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio. It's real business momentum but the stock can swing 10% in a day, so don't oversize it.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$215-225 before adding — today's 10% pop is chase territory. The stock had a \$216 print two days ago, so that level could get retested on any macro wobble.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is a second hyperscaler deal announcement (Microsoft would be huge) and Q3 earnings guidance that bakes in the Google economics.

WHEN TO BAIL: If any hyperscaler publicly walks away from custom silicon, or if Q3 guidance disappoints on custom chip revenue growth, I'm cutting. Also watch for CEO Matt Murphy — losing him would be a red flag.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — trim 25% of the position on any rip above \$270 to lock in gains, then let the rest ride. If you want portfolio-level protection, own some cash or short an overheated AI name against it.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$36.58 · 1M: +53.5% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$23.7B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
2	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$146.31 · 1M: +36.7% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$18.4B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
3	GTLB	GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$42.60 · 1M: +25.0% · P/S: 7.2x · Cap: \$7.2B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$48 entry				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
4	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology	8.2/10	BUY
Price: \$172.74 · 1M: +21.1% · P/S: 4.4x · Cap: \$8.8B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
5	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	WATCH
Price: \$440.53 · 1M: +36.2% · P/S: 13.6x · Cap: \$35.4B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$260 entry				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	